KEY POINT Data mesh is easier to implement in companies in which software is developed in close cooperation with data experts.

FOLLOWING THE DOMAIN-DRIVEN DESIGN APPROACH

Domain orientation is at the core of data mesh. Even if your teams do not consciously use the *domain-driven design* approach, you might consider how closely they follow its principles in their day-to-day operations. To evaluate the cost in effort of turning your teams' focus to domains, ask these three key questions about their activities:

- How close are they to the core of the domain? How closely does their work follow domain logic?
- Do they base their software and data designs on domain models?
- Do they collaborate with domain experts?

We covered some of these questions separately when considering other drivers. However, putting them together may provide a clear picture of the difficulty in implementing the domain ownership principle in your organization.

KEY POINT A data mesh is easier to implement in companies that are following a domain-driven design approach.

None of the described drivers, alone or in combination, give you a clear go/no-go answer as to when you should start your data mesh journey (neither does their combination). To understand whether a data mesh is the right path for your organization (or even the right solution to solve your business case), you need to compare it to the alternatives.

2.1.5 Is a data mesh a good fit for me?

You need to ask yourself one critical question: is your current socio-technical architecture capable of supporting your current and planned business operations sufficiently? That is why, at the beginning of this chapter, we encouraged you to consider the business case. There is a chance a data mesh could help you if one or more of the following apply to you: